

Research Question	Hypothesis	Sampling plan	Analysis Plan	Rationale for sensitivity decisions	Interpretation given different outcomes	Theory that could be shown wrong by the outcomes
R1: How is integrity influenced by role and QRP severity?	H1a: Scientific inspectors will be rated higher in Integrity than scientific investigators	Participants will be recruited through the University of Alabama participant pool and compensated with course credit. Participants will be excluded if they: 1) do not consent or 2) complete the study in less than seven minutes or 3) exhibit no variability in their responses (e.g., selecting all 5s or all 3s) across all trust and likeability items, and 4) fail to complete the trust and likeability ratings for at least one vignettes. Participants will also be recruited through prolific and BeSample if funding opportunities arise.	Model 1: $Integrity_{ijk} = \gamma_{000} + \gamma_{100} (Researcher_j) + v_{0k} + \mu_{0jk} + \varepsilon_{ijk}$ Random intercepts for participants (Level 3) and vignettes (Level 2); random slopes for within-participant predictors where possible.	The study was powered based on the smallest effect size of interest, defined as differences in ethical perceptions of researcher roles, drawn from prior literature. Assuming a conservative ICC of .50, the required sample size was estimated at 566 participants to achieve 80% power for detecting a small effect size ($d = .24$, $f^2 \approx .014$) with Bonferroni-corrected $\alpha = 0.001$ for five planned comparisons.	Main effect of role: higher integrity ratings for inspector vs. investigator	If there is no effect then it stands to question theories pertaining to the role of QRPs on laypersons perceptions.
	H1b: Integrity gap widens with QRP severity		Model 4: $Integrity_{ijk} = \gamma_{000} + \gamma_{100} (Researcher_j) + \gamma_{010} (Severity_k) + \gamma_{110} (Researcher_j \times Severity_k) + v_{0k} + \mu_{0jk} + \varepsilon_{ijk}$		Significant interaction: integrity difference between roles (inspector – investigator) increases with severity	
R2: How is likeability influenced by role and QRP severity?	H2a: Scientific investigators will be rated as more likeable than scientific inspectors		Model 1: $Likeability_{ijk} = \gamma_{000} + \gamma_{100} (Researcher_j) + v_{0k} + \mu_{0jk} + \varepsilon_{ijk}$; Random intercepts for participants (Level 3) and vignettes (Level 2); random slopes for within-participant predictors where possible.	Assuming a conservative ICC of .50, the required sample size was estimated at 566 participants to achieve 80% power for detecting a small effect size ($d = .24$, $f^2 \approx .014$) with Bonferroni-corrected $\alpha = 0.001$ for five planned comparisons.	Main effect of role: higher likeability for investigator vs. inspector	If there is no effect on likeability it brings questions to theories on social perceptions of whistleblowers as well as theories pertaining to perceptions of “tattletalers.”
	H2b: Likeability gap narrows (or even reverses) with the increase of QRP severity		Model 4: $Likeability_{ijk} = \gamma_{000} + \gamma_{100} (Researcher_j) + \gamma_{010} (Severity_k) + \gamma_{110} (Researcher_j \times Severity_k) + v_{0k} + \mu_{0jk} + \varepsilon_{ijk}$		Significant interaction: Likeability difference between roles (inspector – investigator) decreases with severity.	
R3: Is the perceived trueness of the finding influenced by QRP severity?	H3: Perceived trueness will decrease as QRP severity increases.		Model FT1: $Trueness_{ijk} = \gamma_{000} + \gamma_{010} (Severity_k) + v_{0k} + \mu_{0j} + \varepsilon_{ijk}$; random intercepts for participants		Main effect of severity: trueness decreases as severity increases	Should we find no effect on perceived trueness then it stands to question theories on the ability to update scientific beliefs when faced with misinformation.